Thankfully, Clauser was alerted to the problem in the letter and didn't use it for his job applications. Instead, Shimony, d'Espagnat, and others wrote glowing letters in support of Clauser. But Thaddeus wasn't the only one who thought Clauser's work wasn't truly scientific. "When I saw d'Espagnat last week he had a letter from the Dep't Chairman at San Jose, inquiring whether what you have been doing is real physics," Shimony wrote to Clauser. "Needless to say, he'll write a strong letter answering the question in your favor." But their efforts led nowhere: Clauser couldn't get a permanent academic job.

Clauser, at least, was not suffering from the same isolation that Zeh faced in Heidelberg. After arriving in Berkeley, Clauser had fallen in with a group of eccentric physics students and junior faculty who shared his interests in the foundations of quantum physics. Inspired by the counterculture of the time and place—Haight Ashbury, the center of the hippie movement, was just a short hop across the San Francisco Bay—these physicists hoped that their investigations would lead to a new way of doing physics, in line with their interests in Eastern philosophy, extrasensory perception, and the mind-expanding powers of psychedelic drugs. They called themselves the "Fundamental Fysiks Group," and their discussions centered around turning on, tuning in, and dropping out of the Copenhagen interpretation.

Although this group certainly provided a moral support network for Clauser, it couldn't help him find a job—indeed, most of the other members of the group had trouble securing permanent positions for themselves. The prejudice against work in quantum foundations wasn't the only reason: if anything, the lack of work was part of what drove their interest in the subject. The postwar boom in physics funding that had fueled the rise of "shut up and calculate!" was coming to a sudden and precipitous end. As the Cold War cooled off into détente, deep cuts in defense spending at the end of the 1960s meant less funding for physicists from the US government. And protests against classified research on university campuses across the country weakened the link between academia and the military-industrial complex. The upshot was a dramatic shortage of jobs for physicists. Immediately after World War II, physics had grown faster than any other academic field—now, it shrank faster than the rest. From the end of the war up through the mid-1960s, there were never enough freshly minted PhDs in